

Summary for OLAT Upload

Two initial impressions on strengths/weaknesses of qualitative research:

1. Strength: Qualitative research excels at contextual depth and theory generation. It studies phenomena in the field, takes context seriously, and can produce rich, practice-relevant theory that integrates multiple levels of analysis. It has demonstrated outsized impact in terms of awards and influential papers.

2. Weakness: Qualitative research struggles with legitimacy and quality assessment. The absence of a single standard (unlike quantitative metrics) leads to inappropriate application of positivist criteria. Open science pressures (preregistration, data sharing) may further marginalize qualitative methods, even when such practices are often impossible or unethical.